

## Chapter 05

### Groups & Organizations

A social group consists of two or more people who regularly interact and share a sense of unity and common identity.

**A.W. Green** says "An aggregate of individuals which persists in time, which has one or more interests or activities in common and which is organized".

**Emory S. Bogardus**: "a number of persons, two or more who have common objects of attention, who are stimulating to each other, who have common loyalty and participate in related activities are called as group".

Examples of social groups are: family, friends, peer group, neighbors, classmates, organizations, clans, and religious groups, relations of teacher and student, buyer and seller, voter and candidate, members of a political party, members of same profession. You could be a member of a sports team, club, church group, college class, workplace, and more.

#### Characteristics of Social Groups

Following are the characteristics of Groups:-

- **Collection of individuals**: Two or more individuals form a group.
- **Interaction among Members**: Reciprocal Relations exists among its members.
- **Mutual awareness**: Group members are aware of one another and their behaviors.
- **Common Interest**: These are formed for Common Goals and Objectives.
- **Group Unity & Solidarity** Having Sense of unity and solidarity which results loyalty and sympathy.
- **We-Feeling**: A sense of we feeling is present among members of groups which develops cooperation.
- **Group Norms (Values, customs, traditions, folkways etc.)**: Group Norms and regulations (written or unwritten) must be followed for group control.
- **Influence on Personality**: Social groups directly or indirectly influence the personality.

## Types of Social Groups

We may classify social groups from various viewpoints. If we consider the nature of social contact and intensity of social interaction the types of social group will be as such:

- 1.Primary Groups & Secondary Groups
- 2.In-Group& Out-Group
- 3.Formal and Informal

### 1. Primary Groups & Secondary Groups:

#### Primary Groups:

Charles H. Cooley was the first sociologist to use the term primary groups to describe such groups as family, neighborhood and children's play groups.

According to Charles Horton Cooley (1864–1929), a primary group is a small social group whose members share personal and lasting relationships.

Primary groups are joined by primary relationships; people who spend a great deal of time together, engage in a wide range of activities, and feel that they know one another pretty well. In short, they show real concern for one another. The family in every society is the most important primary group.

The primary group is primary in the sense that the members are emotionally attached together sharing their basic ways of life with one another.

Primary groups are distinguished by some of the following characteristics:

- **Small in size:** Primary groups are often small in size.
- **Face to Face Interaction:** There is face-to-face interaction among members.
- **We-Feeling:** There is high sentiment or loyalty.
- **Intimacy:** Identification and close cooperation among members
- **Strong Attachment:** There is a high level of emotional, spiritual satisfaction to be derived from involvement in primary social groups.
- **Frequent Interaction:** interaction among members of group is frequent and it can be many times a day.

**Examples of primary groups are:** family, friends, peers, neighbors, clans, and church members.

#### Secondary Groups:

Secondary group is a large and impersonal social group whose members pursue a specific goal or activity. Secondary groups are large groups whose relationships are impersonal and goal oriented; their

relationships are temporary. Secondary group have Secondary relationships which involve weak emotional ties and little personal knowledge of one another.

### **Characteristics of Secondary Group**

- **Large in size:** Its members are relatively larger in size than the primary one. They can be thousands and hundreds of thousands of members.
- **Less physical proximity:** Their physical proximity is rarely found and most of the members reside quite way from each other.
- **Impersonal or secondary relation:** Its basic elements are indirect, impersonal contractual as well as non-inclusive relations. Usually, they come close to each other for achieving common interests.
- **Membership:** Membership in this case is mainly voluntary. Individuals are free to join or avoid it. There is no emotional bondage on the members.
- **Specific ends or interests:** Members of the secondary groups are interested just because they have specific ends to aim at. That's why, it is also called special interest group.
- **Social control:** Here means of social control are usually formal. Laws and other regulations are enforced on the members by the authorities. The degree of relationship among members is not very strong here. This group is second in importance.

**Examples:** The relations of teacher and student, buyer and seller, voter and candidate, class fellows, relatives, members of a political party, members of same profession are examples of secondary group.

## **2. In-Group and Out-Group:**

### **In-group:**

A social group toward which a member feels respect and loyalty. In groups are the groups with which an individual identifies himself completely. Member of in group has feelings of attachment, sympathy and affection towards the other members of these groups.

In groups are generally based on a consciousness of kind. Members of in-group identify themselves with the word 'we' and it is based on the idea that 'we' have value traits and that 'they' lack.

Examples: They may be Members of his family, neighborhood, play-group or immediate or close relatives, Pakistani Team with ref to Indian team, outfitters with ref to Diners.

### **Characteristics of In-Group**

- **Ethnocentrism:** The members of in group consider their group superior than other groups.

- **Similar Behavior:** Members of in-group almost show similar behavior and they are similar in many respects. They show similar attitude, opinion and similar reactions.
- **We-feeling:** Members of in-group have a strong sense of We-feeling by which they identify themselves and distinguish them from others.
- **Sense of Unity:** Members of in group are united by a strong sense of unity.
- **Love, Sympathy and fellow-feeling:** This is another important characteristic of in group. Good human qualities like love, sacrifice, sympathy, mutual help and fellow feeling develop only in an in group

## Out Group:

A social group toward which a person feels a sense of competition or opposition 'Out group' members are considered in relation to in-group. Those not included in 'we' and fall in 'they' are the members of out-group, its members are not members of individuals self. We (in-group) the Russians, they (out-group) the Americans: we the *Pathans* and they the *Sayyed* are the examples. It means a person member of a certain group falls in its in-group and a person not member to a group falls in his out-group.

### Characteristics of out-group

Like in group, out group is also found in all societies. Out group have the following characteristics:

- Dissimilar behavior is marked between the member of in group and out group.
- Out group identify itself with the help of 'they' or other feeling. Individual is not a member of this group. Hence this kind of feeling develops among them.
- Individual expresses a feeling of antagonism or enmity towards out group. Sometimes individual consider out group as his enemy.
- Individual always expresses or shows negative attitude towards the out group. As a result he does not identify himself with the out group.
- Out group is not based on ethnocentrism.

## 3. Formal and Informal Groups:

### Formal group:

A formal group is a collection of persons, who came together for achieving a specified goal under some specified rules and regulations. Those who fulfill the conditions become the members of formal group but if they violate the rules their membership maybe cancelled. They are always created with intent to fulfill some official requirement. Formation of the group is done by the management. It possesses a systematic structure, in hierarchical form.

- Here membership is defined. Those who fulfill the conditions can become member.
- The entry is made under written rule and the membership can be cancelled on violation of its rules and regulations.

**Examples:** The students in a class are a formal group, United Nations Organization (U.N.O.), SAARC, Punjab Professors and Lecturers Association (PPLA), Youth Club in a *mohalla*, are also formal groups.

## Informal group

- It is a group in which rules and regulations are not define.
- Informal group membership is not defined. Any person can participate and leave it when he likes.
- People listening radio, watching television, listening to a speaker and enjoying the feats of an acrobat on the roadside, people gossiping in *mohalla* and children playing in street, are the examples of informal groups.

| BASIS FOR COMPARISON          | FORMAL GROUP                                                                                 | INFORMAL GROUP                                                                                                                   |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Meaning</b>                | A formal group is a collection of persons, who came together for achieving a specified goal. | An informal group is formed when two or more people come together to accomplish a specific task which is mainly socially geared. |
| <b>Formation</b>              | Deliberately                                                                                 | Voluntarily                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Size</b>                   | Large                                                                                        | Comparatively small.                                                                                                             |
| <b>Life</b>                   | Depends on the type of group.                                                                | Depends on the members.                                                                                                          |
| <b>Structure</b>              | Well Defined                                                                                 | Not properly Defined                                                                                                             |
| <b>Importance is given to</b> | Position                                                                                     | Person                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Relationship</b>           | Professional                                                                                 | Personal                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Communication</b>          | Moves in a defined direction.                                                                | Stretches in all the directions.                                                                                                 |

## RELATERD TERMS

### Caste

- Caste is a permanent social group in which the status of an individual is fixed through heredity alone.
- The members of a caste usually create Biradri in Indo-Pakistani societies.
- Caste is the described status received at birth.
- Caste is an element in determining social stratification in our society.
- The people of the same caste from Biradri for intermarriages. Therefore the binding force of Biradri creates Social control among the people.
- This caste system still prevalent Indian and Pakistani society.

### Pressure-Group

- A pressure group is an organization which attempts to influence government policies through protests and demonstrations. Pressure groups are formed when people with similar opinions get together for similar objectives. Examples of pressure groups are Business Groups, Student's Organizations, religious groups etc.

### Reference group

A group that serves as a point of reference in making evaluations and decisions. Example maybe professional group, family and caste.

## Formal Organization & Types of Formal Organizations

A formal organization is a type of group that is deliberately (consciously and intentionally) constructed and whose members are organized to achieve a specific goal in the most efficient manner.

**Formal organizations** are large secondary groups organized to achieve their goals efficiently.

According to Chester Banard “an organization is formal when the activities are coordinated towards a common objective”. He found that the essence of formal organization is conscious common purpose and that formal organization comes into being when persons.

Formal organizations i.e. secondary groups designed to achieve explicit objectives, have become a central feature of contemporary society. Such organizations are deliberately created ‘social machines with human parts’. In these organizations social relations are impersonal, formal, and planned. These organizations have major influence on the everyday lives of members of modern societies.

### Characteristic of Formal Organizations:

Following are the main characteristics of formal organization

1. Organization structure stands on division of labor/ Hierarchical work which brings efficiency in organizations’ operations.
2. A written set of rules, policies, and procedures.
3. Individual activities are limited
4. Organizations communicate messages through straight chain of command

Examples: Examples can be business corporations, government departments, colleges and universities, hospitals, prisons, and military organizations.

### Types of Formal Organizations:

Amitai Etzioni has identified three types of formal organizations, distinguished by the reasons people participate in them:

1. Utilitarian organizations,
2. Normative organizations, and
3. Coercive organizations.

#### 1. Utilitarian Organizations:

People voluntarily join utilitarian organizations when they can provide them with a material reward they seek. To make a living or earn a college degree, they must participate in organizations that can provide them these opportunities. Although they have some choice regarding where they work or attend school, utilitarian organizations are not always completely



voluntary. For example, most people must continue to work even if the conditions of their employment are less than ideal.

## 2. **Normative Organizations:**

People voluntarily join normative organizations when they want to pursue some common interest or gain personal satisfaction or prestige from being a member. Political parties, ecological activist Groups, religious organizations, parent– teacher associations, and college philanthropists groups, are examples of normative, or voluntary organizations. Class, gender, and race are important determinants of a person’s participation in a normative organization.

## 3. **Coercive Organizations:**

People do not voluntarily become members of coercive organizations, rather they are forced to join them. Total institutions, such as boot camps, prisons, and some mental hospitals, are examples of coercive organizations. The assumed goal of total institutions is to socialize people through incarceration. These environments are characterized by restrictive barriers (such as locks, bars, and security guards) that make it impossible for people to leave freely. When people leave without being officially dismissed, their exit is referred to as an “escape.”

## **Bureaucracy**

A bureaucracy is an organizational model characterized by a hierarchy of authority, a clear division of labor, explicit rules and procedures, and impersonality in personnel matters. Sociologist Max Weber was interested in the historical trend toward bureaucratization that accelerated during the Industrial Revolution. To Weber, the bureaucracy was the most “rational” and efficient means of attaining organizational goals because it contributed to coordination and control. According to Weber, rationality is the process by which traditional methods of social organization, characterized by informality and spontaneity, are gradually replaced by efficiently administered formal rules and procedures. Bureaucracy can be seen in all aspects of our lives, from small colleges with perhaps a thousand students to multinational corporations employing many thousands of workers worldwide.

### **Characteristics of Bureaucracy:**

Weber set forth several ideal-type characteristics of bureaucratic organizations. These characteristics have been elaborated as under.

**Division of Labor:** Bureaucratic organizations are characterized by specialization, and each member has highly specialized tasks to fulfill.



**Hierarchy of Authority:** In a bureaucracy, each lower office is under the control and supervision of a higher one. Those few individuals at the top of the hierarchy have more power and exercise more control than do the many at the lower levels. Those who are lower in the hierarchy report to (and often take orders from) those above them in the organizational pyramid. Persons at the upper levels are responsible not only for their own actions but also for those of the individuals they supervise.

**Rules and Regulations:** Rules and regulations establish authority within an organization. These rules are typically standardized and provided to members in a written format. In theory, written rules and regulations offer clear-cut standards for determining satisfactory performance so that each new member does not have to reinvent the rules.

**Qualification-Based Employment:** Bureaucracies require competence and hire staff members and professional employees based on specific qualifications. Individual performance is evaluated against specific standards, and promotions are based on merit as spelled out in personnel policies.

**Impersonality:** Bureaucracies require that everyone must play by the same rules and be treated the same. Personal feelings and emotions should not interfere with organizational decisions.

**Separation of Personal and Public Ends:**

Officials cannot use their official positions for their personal ends. The office property is separated from personal property.

**Discipline:** The officials are subject to great discipline in the conduct of their work. Owing to this discipline bureaucracy succeed in achieving the goals efficiently.

**Formal, written communications:** It is said that the heart of bureaucracy is not people but paperwork. Instead of the casual, face-to-face talk that characterizes interaction within small groups, bureaucracy relies on formal, written memos and reports, which accumulate in vast files.

**Rationality:** It is based on the rationality, means decisions and evaluation in the bureaucracy are made on rational basis rather than personal factors.

## **Problems of Bureaucracy**

We rely on bureaucracy to manage everyday life efficiently, but many people are uneasy about large organizations. Bureaucracy can dehumanize and manipulate us, and some say it poses a threat to political democracy.

1. **Bureaucratic Alienation:** Max Weber held up bureaucracy as a model of productivity. However, Weber was keenly aware of bureaucracy's ability to dehumanize the people it is supposed to serve. The same impersonality that fosters efficiency also keeps officials and clients from responding to one

another's unique personal needs. Formal organizations breed alienation, according to Weber, by reducing the human being to —a small cog in a ceaselessly moving mechanism.

2. **Bureaucratic Ritualism** Weber coined this term to describe a focus on rules and regulations to the point of undermining an organization's goals. In short, rules and regulations should be a means to an end, not an end in them that takes the focus away from the organization's stated goals.

3. **Bureaucratic inertia:** It refers to the tendency of bureaucratic organizations to perpetuate them. Formal organizations tend to take on a life of their own beyond their formal objectives.

4. **Oligarchy:** Early in the twentieth century, Robert Michels pointed out the link between bureaucracy and political oligarchy, the rule of the many by the few.

### **Mechanism to control over Bureaucracy**

**Collegiality:** This mechanism suggests more than one person must have the decision making power. It will be helpful to control the misuse of power and corruption.

**Separation of Power:** It means dividing responsibility and functions between two or more bodies to avoid making a single body holding all the powers. If power will be distributed among more bodies, it will ensure efficiency as well.

**Direct Democracy:** Placing bureaucrats under the supervision and guidance of an assembly/parliament to ensure their accountability to the people. If the bureaucrats will be answerable and accountable to the elected members, there is possibility to ensure public welfare.